

# Audit & Reporting Q&A Copilot

Every step, start to finish, including the current (2026) way to build the tool in Step 6 — an agent flow writing to a new SharePoint list and notifying via Teams.

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What You're Building

An agent that answers audit and journal questions with citations, and lets auditors formally flag control exceptions, grounded in one data file, acting through one governed tool.

|               |                                                                 |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| AGENT NAME    | Audit & Reporting Q&A Copilot                                   |
| ORCHESTRATION | Generative (AI-led)                                             |
| KNOWLEDGE     | Finance_Audit_Data.xlsx                                         |
| CUSTOM TOPIC  | Investigate Control Exception                                   |
| TOOL          | Flag Journal for Audit Review (agent flow → SharePoint + Teams) |

Files & Where They Go

| FILE / ITEM                      | GOES TO                                                      | USED IN |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Finance_Audit_Data.xlsx          | Copilot Studio → <b>Knowledge</b> tab → Add knowledge → File | Step 3  |
| "Audit Findings" SharePoint list | Create manually — see Step 6a for columns                    | Step 6  |

**Before you start** — confirm Environment Maker permission, and Contribute access on the SharePoint site that will host the Audit Findings list.

# Set Up the Agent

Steps 1–3 — create the agent shell, pick how it reasons, and ground it in data.

## 1 Create Your Copilot Studio Agent

Open Copilot Studio ([copilotstudio.microsoft.com](https://copilotstudio.microsoft.com)), select **Create** → **New agent**, then configure:

|                        |                                                                                                                                              |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| AGENT NAME             | Audit & Reporting Q&A Copilot                                                                                                                |
| DESCRIPTION            | Answers questions on month-end actuals, journal variances, control exceptions, and audit trail for cost-centre owners and internal auditors. |
| SOLUTION / ENVIRONMENT | Finance Solution · Default environment                                                                                                       |
| ICON                   | Use a recognisable colour and emoji or upload a brand icon                                                                                   |

## 2 Choose Orchestration Mode

Under **Settings** → **Generative AI**, use **Generative Orchestration** (AI-led) so the agent can blend knowledge lookups with tool calls for audit, journal review and control exceptions.

## 3 Add Knowledge

**Knowledge tab** → **Add knowledge** → **File** → upload **Finance\_Audit\_Data.xlsx**. Contains:

- Journal data (journal ID, period, cost centre, account, description)
- Amounts (debit USD, credit USD, net USD)
- Control signals (control flag — Pass / Review / Fail, variance vs budget %)
- Audit trail (approver, posted date)

You can layer additional sources later — SharePoint sites, Dataverse, public web, or Graph connectors.

# Behavior: Instructions & Topic

Steps 4–5 — tell the agent how to behave, then give it a reusable conversation flow.

## 4 Add Agent Instructions

Overview → Instructions — paste exactly:

You are the Audit & Reporting Q&A Copilot. You help two audiences:

- 1) Cost centre owners reviewing their journals.
- 2) Internal auditors reviewing the control exceptions queue.

Rules:

- Use the uploaded journal dataset as your single source of truth.
- Always cite the JournalID for every number you quote.
- Never invent or round numbers – quote them as recorded.
- Flag rows with ControlFlag = Fail at the top of any answer.
- For actions (flag a journal for review), call the tool – do not just say it is flagged.
- Owners only see their own cost centre rows; auditors see everything.

## 5 Add a Custom Topic

Topics → Add a topic → Create from description:

**Topic name:** Investigate Control Exception

**Description:** Walks an auditor through the rows currently flagged Fail or Review, explains the control rule that fired, and offers to formally raise the exception for follow-up.

**Trigger phrases:**

- Show me control exceptions for this period
- What journals failed control
- Investigate the Fail rows
- Walk me through control issues

**Conversation steps:**

- Ask for the period (default: most recent in data)
- Filter ControlFlag in (Fail, Review), order by absolute NetUSD desc
- For each row, cite JournalID, CostCentre, Account, NetUSD, VarianceVsBudgetPct
- Explain the likely control rule that fired (e.g. variance > 10%)
- Ask which JournalID to formally flag – if any
- Call 'Flag Journal for Audit Review' with the chosen JournalID and reason

# Build the Tool (Current Method)

Step 6 — updated for 2026, using current Copilot Studio tool-building.

## 6a Create the SharePoint List First

SharePoint site → **New** → **List** → **Blank list** → name it **Audit Findings**. Add columns: **JournalID** (text), **Period** (text), **FindingCategory** (Choice: Variance, Control, Documentation, Other), **AuditorNote** (multi-line text), **SuggestedAction** (Choice: Reclass, Reverse, Document, No action), **Status** (Choice: Open, Resolved).

## 6b Build the Agent Flow

1. **Flows** → **New flow** → **Agent flow**.
2. Trigger inputs: **JournalID**, **Period**, **FindingCategory**, **AuditorNote**, **SuggestedAction**.
3. Action: **SharePoint** — **Create item** → list **Audit Findings** → map the fields.
4. Action: **Teams** — **Post your own adaptive card as the Flow bot to a user/channel** → the cost-centre owner and the internal audit lead.
5. **Respond to the agent** → output **FindingID** from the SharePoint item's ID. Confirm **Asynchronous response = Off**.
6. **Publish** the flow.

## 6c Attach It as a Tool

1. **Tools** → **Add a tool** → filter by **Flow** → select it → **Add and configure**.
2. **Name**: Flag Journal for Audit Review. **Description**: "Files a formal audit finding against a journal row and notifies the owner and audit lead."
3. Under **Completion**, respond using the returned **FindingID**.
4. **Save**.

**Original spec, for reference** — Tool: Flag Journal for Audit Review. Type: Power Automate flow → SharePoint list 'Audit Findings' + Teams adaptive card. Files a formal audit finding against a specific journal row, notifies the cost-centre owner and the internal audit lead. Inputs: Journal ID (string, from knowledge); Period (string, e.g. '2026-04'); Finding category (Variance / Control / Documentation / Other); Auditor note (string); Suggested action (Reclass / Reverse / Document / No action). Outcome: Returns the audit finding ID and posts an adaptive card to the cost-centre owner and the internal audit lead.

# Configure, Evaluate, Test, Publish

Steps 7–10 — lock down settings, prove quality, and ship it.

## 7 Configure Settings

Settings cog (top right) — four areas before real users touch the agent:

- **General** — confirm name, description, primary language
- **Generative AI** — orchestration mode, content moderation (start at Medium)
- **Authentication** — "Authenticate with Microsoft" so the agent runs as the signed-in user
- **Security** — review DLP policy, enabled channels, end-user authentication

## 8 Evaluate Your Agent

**Analytics** → **Evaluations** → **New evaluation** — "Audit & Reporting Copilot — Baseline v1". Score every response on Groundedness, Relevance, Accuracy.

Input: Show all journals with ControlFlag = Fail in period 2026-04

Expect: Returns rows filtered by Period and ControlFlag=Fail, cites JournalIDs.

Input: Which cost centres had a variance over 10% vs budget?

Expect: Returns rows where VarianceVsBudgetPct > 10, ordered desc, with NetUSD cited.

Input: Flag journal J-2271 for audit review – undocumented vendor accrual

Expect: Triggers the Investigate Control Exception topic and calls Flag Journal for Audit Review.

## 9 Test in the Test Pane

For each query, open **Activity map** to see: which topic/tool/knowledge fired, the inputs collected and outputs returned, citations to source rows, and per-step latency.

## 10 Publish to a Channel

**Recommended for this build:** Microsoft Teams (Finance Controls channel) and M365 Copilot. Pin the agent in the **Finance Controls** Teams channel for auditors; surface it in **Microsoft 365 Copilot** for cost centre owners reviewing their own journals; embed on the Finance intranet 'audit corner' page; or link the agent from the period close Power BI dashboard. Teams and M365 Copilot channels require tenant admin approval.

# Try These Live

Sample queries to run once the agent is built — and what it replaces.

## Control Exceptions

- Show all journals flagged Fail in the current period.
- Which cost centres have the most Review flags this period?

## Variance Lookups

- What is the largest debit posted to cost centre CC-440 this period?
- Show journals with variance > 10% vs budget, biggest absolute value first.

## Governed Action

- Flag journal J-2271 for review — auditor note 'evidence missing'.
- Try a paraphrase: 'this entry looks off, raise it with audit'.

## This agent replaces

- Manual pivots over the GL extract
- Email chains to chase exception explanations
- Audit findings logged in unstructured spreadsheets

## With

- Citations linking every number to a JournalID
- Structured audit findings flowing into SharePoint
- Faster close, with control exceptions surfaced first

**Tip for real-world use** — bind the agent to your authenticated identity via Entra so a cost-centre owner only sees their own rows automatically. Run the evaluation set after every period close.